Suggested user flows for Altru

Prepared by Specbee for Altru | Provider, service and location UX | Updated October 26, 2026

For potential user-flow exploration only. These suggested user flows build on Altru's existing website design. This guide and the clickable mockup are provided solely to explore and discuss how visitors might move between services, providers and locations.

The hospital examples below support discussion of possible visitor journeys. Pages 2-5 pair public-site excerpts with the Altru concept to show how a similar flow might work within Altru's existing design.

Multi-location Hospital examples

Health system	Observed public structure	Application to Altru
Northwestern Medicine	A heart-care overview connects to treatments, locations and teams. Its heart-location page explicitly notes that services vary by location. The general location finder offers city/ZIP, specialty and map/list controls. S1 S2 S3	Keep distinct provider, service and location paths. Let visitors use geography to find relevant places, then confirm the care available there.
UCHealth	The heart-care overview links to specialists and locations. The Longs Peak Hospital heart-care page combines local services, a care team, address, hours and directions. Its vascular-care overview also states that services may vary by location. S4 S5 S6	Use a shared service explanation plus a local offering or program page when local details are substantial. Connect that offering to its actual team and place.
Mayo Clinic Health System	The shared cardiology page connects conditions, treatments, care team and locations, with an early warning that care options vary locally. Cardiology in Mankato has its own location details and provider list. S7 S8	Make local differences visible before visitors assume every treatment is nearby. Use a community-specific page when it adds useful care and provider context.

Potential flows to explore

- **Offer three connected entry points:** find a provider, understand a service, or find a clinic.
- **Explain care once:** maintain the main clinical explanation and show verified offerings by location.
- **Make local capability explicit:** distinguish consultations, testing, rehabilitation and procedures; a disclaimer alone cannot identify the right place.
- **Connect the next step:** link each local offering to the relevant providers and practical location details.

These are observed structural examples, not usability results or a requirement to copy an entire site. Cross-page location persistence and an equivalent treatment-by-location comparison were not verified across these systems. Altru's content relationships still require clinical validation.

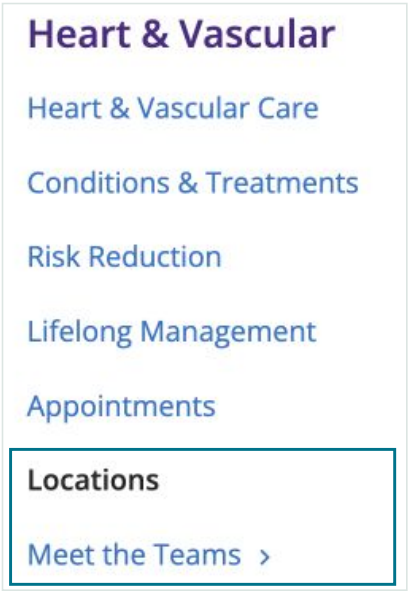
Northwestern Medicine + Altru

Connect service navigation, locations and teams | Visual comparison

The shared pattern is a connected specialty journey. Visitors can understand care, find its locations and reach a relevant team.

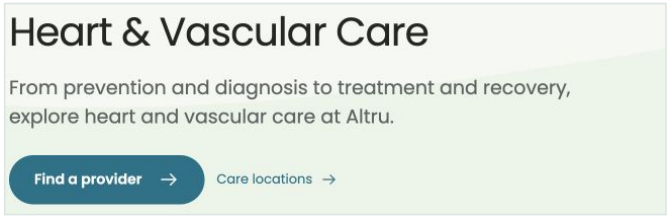
1. Keep place and provider paths in the service journey

PUBLIC SITE | Northwestern Medicine



The Heart & Vascular navigation keeps Locations and Meet the Teams together. Service locations

SPECBEE CONCEPT | Altru



Find a provider opens relevant results; the service content remains visible, with a separate care-location shortcut.

What Altru carries forward

The relationship stays consistent across navigation: a shared service has care locations and relevant teams. Northwestern also connects its local hospital page to cardiovascular subspecialty teams. Local hospital example

Altru application: keep services, places and people connected, then make local capability explicit. Public-site screenshots are references; the anonymous Altru region, care coverage and provider relationships remain illustrative. Cropped excerpts captured October 23, 2026; teal outlines are Specbee annotations.

UCHealth + Altru: local offerings

Separate the local offering from the people who deliver care

UCHealth links from shared heart-care education to specialists or locations. The local Longs Peak Hospital page then describes the care offered at that place.

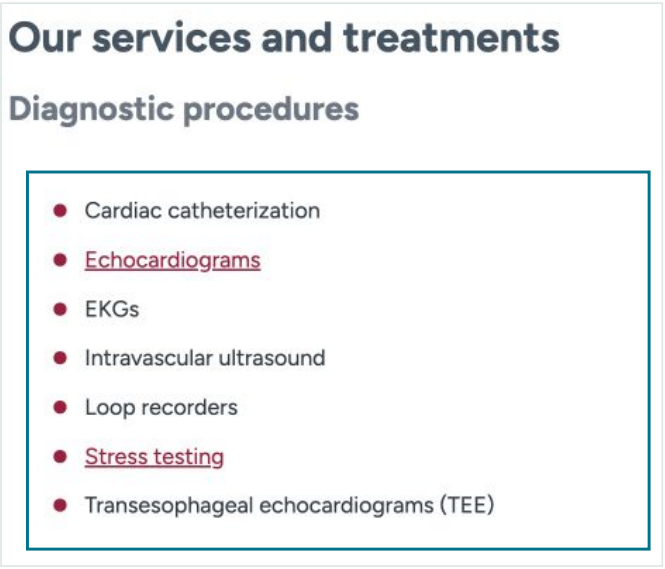
1. PUBLIC SITE | UCHealth heart-care overview



Two distinct links lead to specialists or heart-care locations. Shared service page

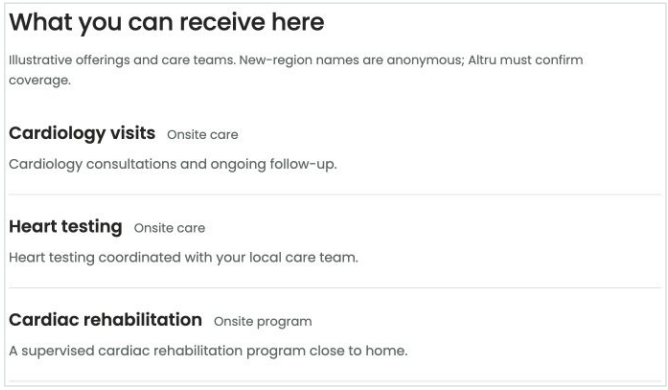
2. Describe what can be received at this location

PUBLIC SITE | Longs Peak Hospital



The local heart-care page lists diagnostic procedures; a separate treatment list follows. Local service page

SPECBEE CONCEPT | Regional Hospital



What you can receive here distinguishes visits, testing and rehabilitation, including onsite delivery.

What Altru makes explicit

The Altru concept separates consultations, testing and rehabilitation, with a delivery label for each. This helps visitors see how a local clinic or hospital differs from other care locations. The sample local page also links onward to the relevant providers.

Altru application: pair verified local capabilities with the relevant care team. A provider's presence does not establish which procedures happen there. All incoming-region names and clinical relationships in the Altru panels are sample content. Cropped October 23, 2026; outlines added by Specbee.

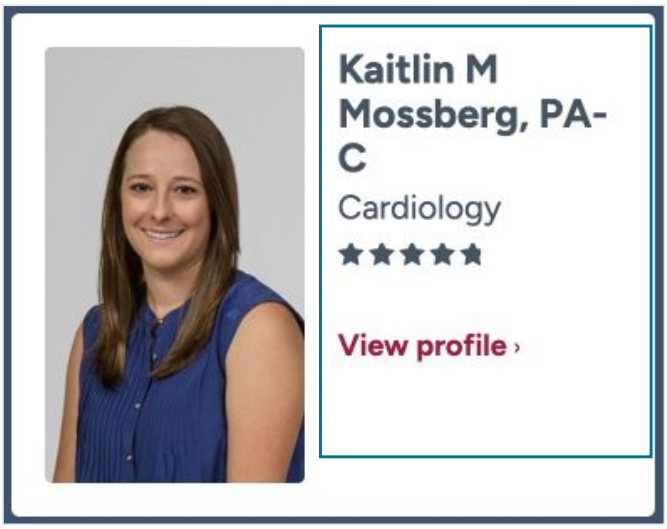
UCHealth + Altru: related providers

A useful local page connects care, people and the next step

Provider cards belong in the context of a local service, so visitors can see which team relates to that offering.

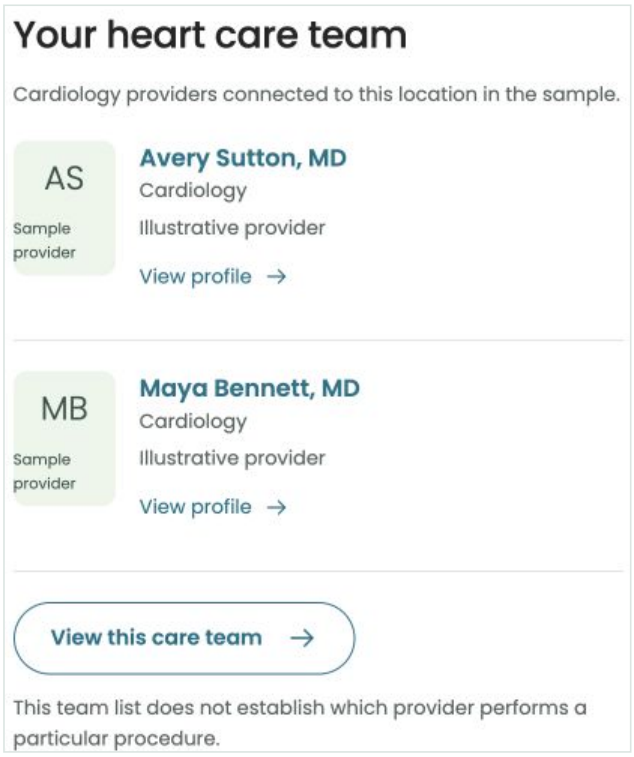
1. Pair the local service with its relevant providers

PUBLIC SITE | Longs Peak Hospital



The local service page includes provider cards and profile links.
Local service page

SPECBEE CONCEPT | Regional Hospital



The same sample local offering shows its cardiology team and links to profiles or provider results.

What the Altru interaction preserves

Opening a profile from Regional Hospital gives that care location priority. View this care team opens provider results with the service and location selected. The visitor can return to the local heart-care page without starting over.

Altru panels show an anonymous demo region and fictional providers. A provider location does not prove that every treatment is performed there; approve service capability separately. Both screenshots are cropped from local service pages. Captured October 23, 2026; teal outlines added by Specbee.

Mayo Clinic Health System + Altru

Shared specialty content connects to local pages and providers

The shared cardiology overview links to community service pages. The Altru concept uses the same relationship, while stating sample local care differences directly on the location summary.

1. Give each local offering a useful destination

PUBLIC SITE | Shared cardiology page



A community card includes practical details and a link to that community's cardiology page. Shared service page

SPECBEE CONCEPT | Shared heart-care page



Regional Hospital's location summary states sample local offerings and opens its dedicated heart-care page.

What the local page adds

A dedicated local page is useful when it provides local care details, contacts or a relevant team. Mayo's cardiology page in Mankato also shows providers and practice communities. Local service and provider example

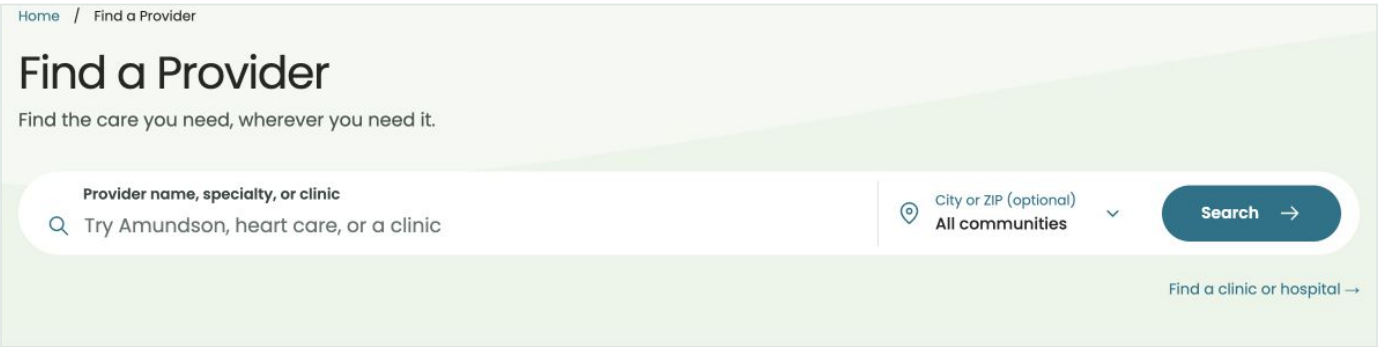
Altru adaptation: maintain shared clinical explanations, then add local content when it helps visitors understand care or choose a team. Local pages should add useful detail rather than duplicate every service/location combination. Anonymous Altru content is illustrative. Captured October 23, 2026; outlines added by Specbee.

One search. No mode selection.

Provider name, specialty or clinic, with an optional starting location

The provider finder now has one search bar. A visitor can enter a known doctor, a specialty or a familiar clinic immediately. The optional city/ZIP selector stays alongside the query; Find a clinic or hospital opens the separate place-finding experience.

SPECBEE CONCEPT | Unified provider search



One query, an optional starting location and a secondary clinic-finder link. The Altru identity and provider results remain familiar.

What the visitor enters	What the experience does
Provider name	Prioritize matching names across communities. Open a result for the profile and care locations.
Specialty or care term	Suggest matching specialties and return relevant providers. Broader service education remains in Services.
Clinic or hospital	Selecting a labeled place suggestion filters its provider team. The clinic finder leads to location details.
City or ZIP (optional)	Prioritize matching care by distance. Keep the starting location changeable and farther name matches visible.

Keep ranking and recovery understandable

Show provider names, specialties and clinics as labeled suggestion groups. Name matches come before broader matches. Preserve explicit filters; when they hide a searched provider, offer Search all Altru providers while retaining the query and starting location.

What to configure in TruSearch

Validate provider-name matching and spelling variants, approved specialty aliases, clinic and former clinic names, ranking rules and provider-location relationships against Altru's real index. Do not require a mode selection to distinguish these queries.

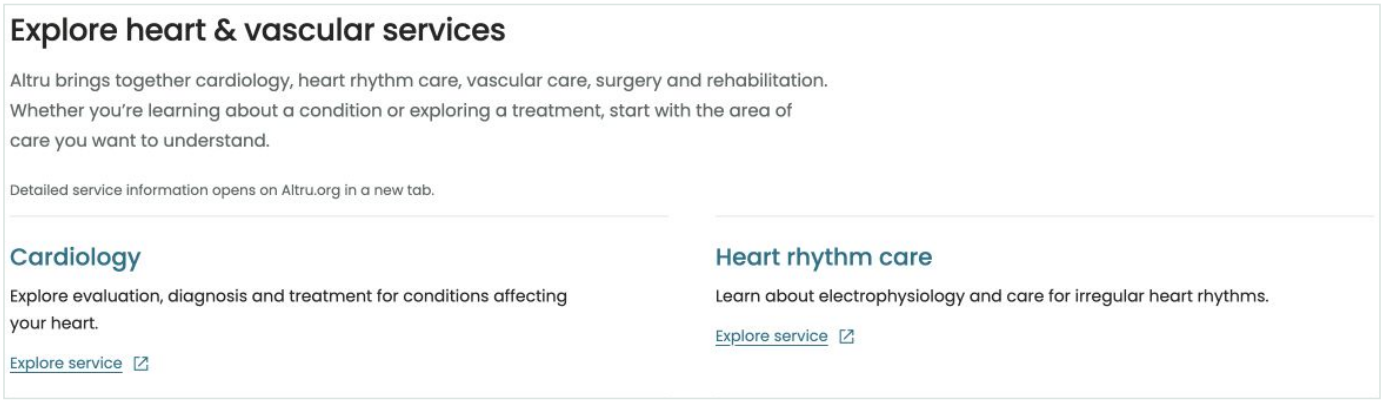
The mockup uses local sample logic, with an anonymous region and illustrative care relationships. Altru's live TruSearch configuration and production search quality still require validation.

A service page is a front door

Understand the care, explore the options, then choose a next step

The Heart & Vascular page supports people arriving to learn, including direct search-engine arrivals. A visible overview and six clinical topic links come before location comparison. Find a provider is the primary button; Care locations remains a secondary shortcut. Reading the next section needs no anchor button.

SPECBEE CONCEPT | Learning before location selection



The shared overview leads into descriptive clinical topics. Detailed service links open existing Altru.org information in new tabs, preserving the concept and its selected origin.

Visitor situation	Natural continuation
Exploring a concern	Read the overview; explore a service topic without choosing a location.
Known diagnosis or treatment	Open relevant clinical information, then return to explore a team or place.
Evaluating Altru	Understand the breadth and care approach; review supported program information.
Ready for local care	Compare explicit offerings and onsite or visiting delivery; open the local team.
Known doctor or clinic	Use the direct provider shortcut or clinic finder without reading every section.

Keep both learning and action available

Page sequence: overview and clinical topics → care approach → local offerings → providers → relevant learning resources. People can skip ahead. Clinical topic links explain care; comparison filters identify where a capability is shown. Keep these two purposes distinct.

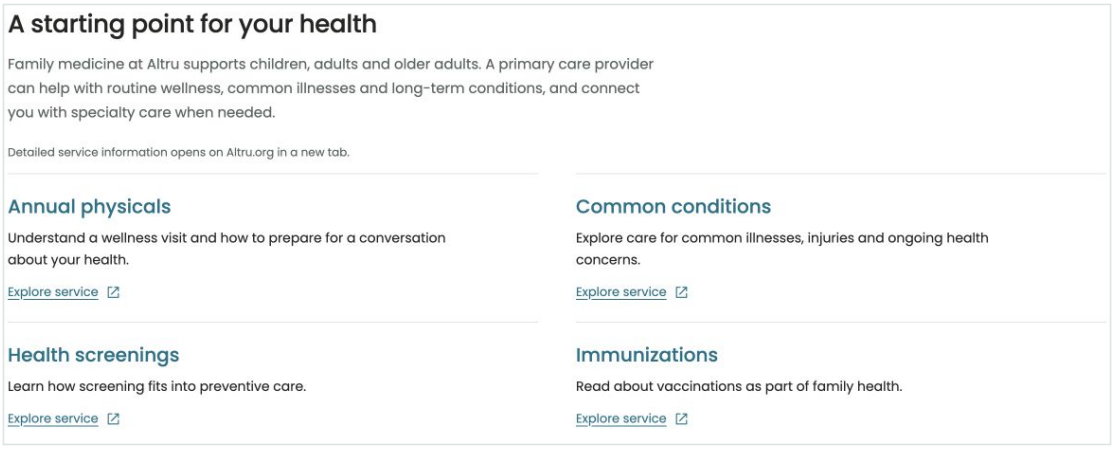
The service branches are grounded in Altru's existing Heart & Vascular content. S10 Prototype copy still requires editorial and clinical review. Incoming-region offerings and provider relationships remain illustrative; no clinical topic establishes availability at every location.

Apply the pattern across services

Useful service content comes before providers and practice locations

Primary care, pediatrics, cancer, kidney care, orthopedics and pregnancy/birth now follow the same reading-first structure as Heart & Vascular. Find a provider is the primary hero button on all seven pages and opens the matching provider results. The service explanation is visible in the page.

SPECBEE CONCEPT | Family Medicine & Primary Care



A useful overview and service topics lead into the care approach. Providers and practice locations follow farther down the page.

Service and public source	Content offered before people and places
Primary care	Continuing care, annual physicals, common conditions, screening and immunizations.
Pediatrics	Well visits, hospital care, pediatric therapy and family prevention topics.
Cancer care	Screening and diagnosis, treatment, cancer types and support for patients and families.
Kidney care	Nephrology, dialysis and home dialysis education; a link to Altru's full service information.
Orthopedics	Medical orthopedics, joint replacement, orthopedic surgery and athletic training.
Pregnancy & birth	Prenatal care and education, labor and delivery, and support after birth.

Show the right level of local detail

The new practice-location sections use the sample provider relationships, with links to place details or that location's service-filtered team. Three places show initially; an inline disclosure reveals additional matches. A chosen origin orders matching places without excluding distant ones.

Practice locations do not prove treatment availability. Only Heart has authored capability comparisons in this concept. Confirm all local offerings independently. Public clinical links open in new tabs, preserve the concept and remain subject to Altru editorial and clinical review.

Start with the visitor's task

Three connected ways in; one Altru experience

Visitors should be able to start with what they know. Some know a doctor's name, some recognize a clinic, and others only know the care they need. They should not have to understand the acquisition or choose a regional website first.

Find a Provider → **Provider profile** → **Care location**

Services menu → **Service + local offering** → **Relevant providers**

Clinic finder → **Location page** → **Services + providers**

Selected starting location stays with the visitor and remains changeable.

Visitor need	Entry and behavior	Reasoning
I know my doctor	Search by first or last name across communities; open the profile and care locations.	A familiar name should remain findable even when branding or regional coverage changes.
I know my clinic	Search a clinic for its providers, or open the clinic finder for location details.	A known place is often more useful than an unfamiliar organizational label.
I am learning about care	Use Services; read the overview; explore a clinical topic; choose people or places when ready.	A service page is a direct entrance for learning as well as finding care.
I want nearby care	Set a city or ZIP; prioritize matching options by distance and show the starting point.	Distance helps compare appropriate care; proximity alone does not establish a match.
I am helping someone else	Use the same flows on a phone; verify the address, phone and directions.	The starting location must be editable and must not assume the device belongs to the patient.

Location is context; a clinic is a filter

Keep the visitor's starting point separate from the clinic whose providers they are viewing. Opening a clinic or a provider profile should not silently replace that starting point. If a particular care location was selected, show it first in that provider's profile.

Location context alone should prioritize relevant care without excluding other communities. Explicit community or distance filters may narrow results; make them visible and easy to clear, and provide a path to farther matching options when local matches are limited.

Expected benefit: less backtracking and fewer mistaken assumptions about where care is available. Validate that benefit with representative visitors; the prototype does not establish a measured improvement.

Explain care once. Show differences locally.

A shared service page with explicit local offerings

The service overview answers what the care is. A local offering answers what can be received at a particular place. A provider listing answers who practices there. Connecting these records avoids duplicating clinical explanations and avoids implying that every location offers the same care.

Illustrative heart-care coverage in the mockup

Care type	Grand Forks hospital	Regional Hospital	North Clinic	Community Hospital West
Cardiology visits	Onsite	Onsite	Visiting specialist	Onsite
Heart testing	Onsite	Onsite	Not shown	Not shown
Cardiac rehabilitation	Not shown	Onsite program	Not shown	Onsite program
Advanced procedures	Hospital-based	Not shown	Not shown	Not shown

All cells are illustrative prototype relationships, including the Grand Forks example. They are not a validated Altru service inventory. "Not shown" means absent from this demo; it does not mean unavailable in real care.

Choose the right content level

Content level	What belongs here	When to use it
Shared service page	Visible overview, clinical topic links, care approach and resources, followed by optional people/place paths.	One Altru overview supports learning and action. Examples: S1 S4
Local offering module	Verified care types, onsite/visiting delivery, relevant team and practical local details.	Use when the service explanation is the same and the differences fit a concise local module.
Dedicated local program page	Distinct treatment program, preparation, care team, contact process or substantial local content.	Use when the local differences change what a visitor needs to understand or do. Avoid an empty page for every service/location combination.
Location page	Address, contact details, directions, hours where verified, About, Services and provider connections.	Keep a useful place-based hub. Altru's current location structure already supports this. S9

A provider's presence is not proof of a treatment capability. A visiting cardiologist can see patients at a clinic without every heart test or procedure taking place there. Clinical owners must approve the care-type-to-location relationship separately.

When care is farther away, explain the travel and keep the starting location. The mockup demonstrates this with advanced procedures from the anonymous region.

Keep each screen focused

Interaction guidance and the reasoning behind the layout

Surface	Recommended behavior	Why it belongs here
Provider finder	One bar accepts a provider name, specialty or clinic, with an optional city/ZIP selector. Suggestions select providers, specialties or clinics. Keep visible refinements and care-location links.	Visitors can enter what they know without choosing a mode. Results remain providers; Services has its own menu and explanatory pages.
Clinic finder	Search is the first field. City/ZIP is available inline. Group origin status and clear/demo actions. Community filtering is a separate refinement.	A familiar clinic name should be quick to enter. A starting location should help the search without becoming a required gate.
Wide-screen map	Align the selected-location map with the result list. Highlight the corresponding row and provide Show on map and directions.	The map explains where a listed place is; it should not compete with the search controls.
Phone finder	Stack controls, use a native Community select, and let the dialog scroll as one surface. Keep location-page/direction links.	Reclaim space from control chrome without shrinking text or touch targets. The overlay map yields when there is insufficient room.
Location page	Put name, address, phone and main actions early. On phones, place them before the exterior. Then show Getting Here, About, Services and providers.	Visitors can verify a place and take the next step before reading background information or scrolling past photography.
Service page	Lead with visible service education and meaningful topic links. Offer direct provider/location shortcuts; group local care and delivery details.	People may arrive to learn before choosing a place. Clinical topics and local capability filters answer different questions.

Keep the next step predictable

- **Related providers:** carry the service/location into provider results and provide a clear return link.
- **Back and close:** preserve origin and visible choices. Dialog Escape should return focus to the initiating control; direct links and browser Back should remain usable.
- **Empty results:** keep the query and starting location visible. Offer a specific reset or widening action; do not turn unrecognized text into an all-results search.
- **Directions:** hand a verified public destination to Google Maps. Let visitors choose their starting point there; do not send a fictional or anonymous destination.
- **Map dependency:** maps need a connection. Keep the address and an external directions link useful when an embedded map cannot be shown.

These are design rules and production acceptance criteria. The mockup demonstrates selected flows; it is not a complete accessibility, geocoding or cross-browser implementation.

Make the content trustworthy

The relationships matter as much as the page design

The experience depends on reliable relationships between people, places and care. A shared page structure cannot resolve inconsistent source data. Confirm the content model and ownership before turning the demo into a production service.

Record	Required relationships and facts	Proposed owner
Provider	Stable ID, public display name, specialty, actual practice locations and delivery mode where confirmed.	Provider-directory owner
Location	Stable ID, approved public/legacy names, address, contact details, department hours, approved services and map destination.	Location operations + web team
Service	Shared clinical explanation, care-type taxonomy, patient-language aliases and links to relevant providers.	Clinical service lead + editorial
Local offering	Service/care type + location + onsite/visiting/other delivery + relevant team + local instructions where verified.	Clinical lead + location owner
Verification	Source of truth, reviewer, verification date, status and next review trigger.	Named content owner

Three content decisions to protect

- **Unknown is different from unavailable.** Do not label a location as lacking care merely because a feed, page or sample has no record. Use approved wording and show validated alternatives.
- **Share the explanation; approve the variation.** Maintain common clinical content once. Store local capabilities separately, with a clear reviewer and update process.
- **Preserve familiar names.** Validate former clinic/provider names as search aliases and plan approved redirects. The prototype's anonymous labels are demonstration content, not a migration inventory.

Decisions still needed for production

Confirm the acquisition's facility/provider inventory, service taxonomy, treatment coverage and visiting schedules; source systems and update ownership; real distance/geocoding behavior; approved names and redirects; and the exact MyChart handoff. Decide whether the clinic overlay also needs a standalone, shareable finder route as the directory grows.

Keep valid existing Altru location and service URLs wherever possible. A shared UX does not settle React, Drupal, Canvas, integrations, estimates or launch timing. Those remain implementation and scope decisions.

Current status: a clickable concept with a sample roster, fixed sample origins/distances, selected search aliases and authored care relationships. It includes 16 anonymous incoming-region facilities for demonstration; the actual inventory still needs confirmation. No scheduling, live availability or general clinical triage is implemented.

Walk through it, then validate it

A short review plan for Altru stakeholders and representative visitors

Open the clickable mockup and use the paths below. Keep the new region anonymous during review. The scenarios test whether people can find the correct care and understand where it happens; they do not validate clinical coverage.

Scenario	Click path	What to check
Learning first	Open Heart & Vascular directly > read service topics > Heart rhythm care.	Understand the service without setting a location. Detailed information opens on Altru.org; the concept stays available.
Known provider	Single search > Amundson > Search > profile > location.	The provider remains findable across communities; the place is clear.
Familiar clinic	Find a clinic or hospital > set 58201 > Family Medicine > View location > providers.	Origin setting leaves the finder open. Location details and the relevant team are easy to reach.
Different local offerings	Services > Heart & Vascular > Regional Hospital; then compare North Clinic.	The visitor understands the sample difference between local testing/rehab and a visiting consultation.
Care farther away	On Heart & Vascular, choose New region and Advanced heart procedures.	The sample Grand Forks option stays discoverable and the reason for travel is clear.
Phone and directions	Find a clinic on a phone > location page > Get directions.	Controls remain usable, the address is verified and Google Maps receives the correct destination.

What to measure

Observe task completion, wrong-location choices, repeated searches, backtracking and recovery from empty results. Ask visitors to explain where their selected care would occur. Establish a baseline and acceptance targets with Altru before claiming improved conversion or reduced confusion.

The current build has 16 passing logic regression tests and exercised responsive flows at 320, 390, 768, 1280 and 1440px. This is prototype verification, not patient usability research or production accessibility certification.

Sources and review boundary

Public pages were reviewed October 23, 2026. Examples support content structure; unobserved features are not treated as absent. Altru recommendations and sample capabilities remain separate from these observations.

[S1] Northwestern Medicine: Heart & Vascular
[S2] Northwestern Medicine: Heart & Vascular Locations
[S3] Northwestern Medicine: Location Finder
[S4] UCHealth: Heart & Vascular Care
[S5] UCHealth: Longs Peak Hospital Heart Care
[S6] UCHealth: Vascular Disease Care
[S7] Mayo Clinic Health System: Cardiology
[S8] Mayo Clinic Health System: Cardiology in Mankato
[S9] Altru: Family Medicine Center location page
[S10] Altru: Heart & Vascular Care